IRELAND

Follow Mr. Hahn, Mrs. Becker and Mrs Wollmi on a trip to the emerald isle!



https://he.edumaps.de/60320/189859/zyd8tdt2xt/w33v4yu2ov

Get into the mood…

- Watch the video and note your feelings.



https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9sDt-CY2_VQ

Being Irish. What does that mean?

- What better could we do to understand the **"Irish Identity"** than visiting an Irish pub and listen to some fine tunes from the voices and fiddles of musicians delivering their goods?

- Enjoy listening to Mr Hahn's Spotify-Playlist on Ireland and get an impression of **Being Irish.**

https://open.spotify.com/playlist/2oOegDQ1bCy42iwPxGxYSe?si=nOQMSK-LQrCFQ_fpknK3Zw

- → tasks on the next slide

Being Irish. What does that mean?

1. Find yourself a travel mate for our journey to the "emerald island". Pack your bags, **listen** to all the songs on the playlist (or find them on youtube if you don't own a Spotify account) and **decide** which tune will be yours for the next lessons.

2. **Describe** your first impressions of your chosen song. **Identify** the issue(s) each song addresses.

3. Find and read the lyrics to **explain** which experiences and events the song refers to. You will have to dome some own research on the history of the artist and the song and maybe read some sources to understand what the lyrics are about.

4. **Identify** aspects of Irish identity the song deals with.

5. **Prepare** a short presentation where you present the history and story of your song and the aspects of Irish identity reflected in the song.

IRISH IDENTITY
- a summary –

The Great Irish Bucket List: 35 places you have to visit

- Go on a trip to great places in Ireland. Look at the pictures and read the texts.
- Pick five places you would like to visit when in Ireland.
- Write a short explanation why you chose these places. You may include pictures.

https://www.discoverireland.ie/irish-bucket-list

A Brief History of Ireland

1. Read the infotext „A Brief History of Ireland“ in your readers.
2. Do the multiple choice tasks on the text and answer the respective questions.
3. Prepare a timeline of the most important historic events that were named in the text.

Where‘s the connection to Ireland?



Irish Identity and Emigration

- Read the short story „Eveline“ by James Joyce, who is an Irish novelist.

1. Outline the problems and expectations of the protagonist.
2. Analyze the protagonist‘s reaction for staying and for leaving.
3. Write an ending for the story.

Key

- 1) **Problems:**

Uncertainty about leaving home
Fear of change and the unknown
Nostalgia for the past
Harsh working conditions and workplace mistreatment
Father's violence and controlling nature
Mother's death and family responsibilities
Anxiety about how others will judge her decision

- **Expectations:**

Hope for a better life in a new country
Desire for respect and a stable marriage
Escape from her father's control
A future free from workplace mistreatment
Longing for love and security with Frank

2) Reaction to Leaving:

•Hopeful
•Dreaming of respect and stability
•Seeking freedom
•Romanticized future with Frank
•Fear of being trapped like her mother
•Desire to escape oppression

Reaction to Staying:

•Safe but restricted
•Nostalgic and sentimental
•Fearful of the unknown
•Duty-bound to family
•Paralyzed by indecision
•Oppressed by past trauma
•Overwhelmed by guilt and obligation

Peer Feedback on writing an ending

Take your partner‘s text and answer the following questions about it.

- **Content & Coherence**
- ✅ Does the ending logically follow from the original story?
  ✅ Does it stay true to Eveline’s character and dilemma?
  ✅ Is the emotional impact of the ending strong and fitting?
- **Style & Language**
- ✅ Does the writing reflect Joyce’s style (e.g., inner thoughts, detailed descriptions)?
  ✅ Are sentences clear and varied in structure?
  ✅ Is the vocabulary appropriate for the tone of the story?
- **Grammar & Mechanics**
- ✅ Are there any spelling or grammar mistakes that should be corrected?
  ✅ Is punctuation used correctly?
  ✅ Are verb tenses consistent and correct?
- **Engagement & Originality**
- ✅ Does the ending feel engaging and compelling?
  ✅ Does it offer a unique but believable resolution?

James Joyce‘s ending of „Eveline“

… As Eveline stands on the docks with Frank, ready to leave Dublin for a new life in Argentina, she is paralyzed by fear and indecision. She recalls her promise to her dying mother to keep the family together and feels the weight of duty pressing down on her. The sounds of the sea and ship blur around her as panic sets in. Just as Frank calls for her to board, she grips the iron railing, unable to move. Her emotions freeze, and she becomes numb, feeling like a helpless, passive figure in her own life. As the ship departs, Frank desperately calls to her, but she does not respond. She watches him go, her face emotionless, trapped in the familiar misery of her old life. In the end, Eveline’s fear and sense of obligation win over her dreams, leaving her motionless, unable to seize the opportunity for change.

Compare this ending to your own endings (similarities and differences).

Explain which ending you prefer and why.











What happened in Ireland to cause such a transformation?



The Celtic Tiger

- Read the text „The Celtic Tiger“ in your reader.
- **Summarize** the text on a poster. Focus on the development of Ireland‘s economy and **explain** the concept of the „Celtic Tiger“.

Tips for the poster.

- **Sketchnote Layout: "The Celtic Tiger – Ireland's Economic Boom"**
- 🟢 **Title (Top Center)**
- Large, bold text: *The Celtic Tiger*
- Small subtitle: *Ireland's Economic Boom and Crisis*
- 🐯 Simple tiger drawing or Irish flag
- 🔵 **Section 1: The Boom (Left Side)**
- 📅 **1994-2007**
- 📈 GDP growth: *6–11% per year*
- 🏗️ Infrastructure boom: roads, metro, rail
- 🏠 Housing boom (sketch a house with € sign)
- ✈️ **Immigration:** People moving *to* Ireland (arrows, stick figures)
- 💰 Foreign investments: Microsoft, Google, Apple logos
- 🔴 **Section 2: The Crash (Right Side)**
- 📅 **2008-2012**
- 📉 Recession starts in 2008
- 🏦 Banking crisis (sketch a collapsing bank)
- 🚪 People leaving Ireland (plane, exit sign)
- 📊 Unemployment rises from *5% to 15%*
- 💥 Real estate bubble bursts (house price drop symbol)

🟢 **Section 3: Recovery (Bottom Center)**

- 📅 **2014-Present**
- 🚀 Economy rebounds (*faster than China!*)
- 🏭 Growth in **pharma & tech** (Intel, Facebook, Twitter icons)
- 🏢 **Austerity measures** work (money bag with € sign)
- 📦 Companies relocating due to Brexit (arrows from UK to Ireland)
- EU **Strong EU ties** (EU flag)

📌 **Extras (Doodles & Icons Around the Page)**

- 💶 Euro symbol for economy
- 🌍 Globe with arrows (showing global impact)
- 🎭 Culture shift: From emigration to immigration

What happened here in the 20th century?



"I remember thinking: God, please let him live, even though I have to give him away."
Belinda Morgan

"The priest forced my mother to leave her home when he found out she was pregnant. He instructed my grandparents to remove her from the community before she could 'contaminate' other girls."
Laura Murphy



Memorial in Tuam, Galway County

Let‘s find out more about the *Tuam Home Scandal.*

- Read the text „Irish mother and baby homes: Timeline of controversy" in your readers.
- Summarize the timeline that is given there.
- Translate the most important information to German.

<u>Additional tasks:</u>

A) Research how the Irish government and the Catholic Church handled the scandal. Assess whether the representatives should deliver a formal apology to the survivors.

B) Watch the movie „Philomena" on Netflix. Present a summary to your class.

What role does religion play in your daily life?

A: Religion is very important to me, and I practice it strongly.

B: Religion is a part of me and I sometimes practice it.

C: I don’t practice, but I agree that religion still influences culture and society.

D: Religion is irrelevant to my life.

Is there a future for the Catholic Church in Ireland?

- Read the respective text in your reader.
- Answer the questions on the next slides.

Questions – part I

1. What was the traditional role of the Catholic Church in Ireland?

A) It was mainly responsible for economic policies.
B) It had a strong influence on politics, education, and social life.
C) It was a minor religious institution with little impact.
D) It was only important for rural communities.

2. Which of the following events significantly weakened the Church's influence in Ireland?

A) The Brexit referendum
B) The Celtic Tiger economic boom
C) The Irish Civil War
D) The legalization of same-sex marriage and abortion

3. What was one major reason for the decline of the Catholic Church in Ireland?

A) The increase in Protestant communities
B) The rise of new political parties
C) Scandals involving abuse and mistreatment within the Church
D) The complete ban of religious education in schools

Questions – part II

4. How did the role of the Church in education change over time?

A) The state took over many responsibilities from the Church.
B) It gained more control over schools and universities.
C) The Church voluntarily stepped back from the education system.
D) Private Catholic schools became the only legal form of education.

5. What was one result of the Church's decline in Ireland?

A) Ireland became an officially atheist country.
B) Church attendance and religious vocations decreased.
C) Catholicism was completely banned from public life.
D) More people converted to Catholicism to save the institution.

Finish the sentence beginnings.

- **Historically, the Catholic Church in Ireland was powerful because…**
- **One consequence of the Church's loss of influence in Ireland is…**
- **For the Catholic Church to regain trust in Ireland, it would need to…**

What do you think?

- Let‘s do a *placemat activity*.
- In class, there will be posters with questions, statements, etc. on it.
- Take a pen with you and walk around.
- Read a poster and write your opinion on it. You should also give reason / arguments for your opinion.
- You may also add to or questions someone else‘s opinion.

"The religious complained that they, unfairly, had to bear the brunt of that anger."

Should blame be shared among Church leaders, the state, or society?

The text argues that the Irish Church was once the most powerful per capita.

What happens when religious institutions hold political and social control?

Financial transparency and accountability could lead to a "Second Reformation“ (a split of the church).
Do you agree?

Ireland has embraced progressive values, rejecting many Catholic teachings in referendums.
Does this mean the Church has no place in modern Ireland?

Faith and institution are not the same. While the Catholic Church may decline, personal belief in God remains strong for many.
Do you agree?

The Catholic Church once dictated Irish laws on divorce, contraception, and abortion. Now, Irish people have reclaimed those decisions.
Is this progress or a loss of tradition?

Follow-Up Activity

- Have a look at the skill sheet „How to write a comment“.
- Pick one of the statements from the placemats. Take a picture of it.
- Now, write a comment on your chosen statement. You may make use of the arguments provided on the poster already.